



AI LITERACY

Three ways AI fails

The failure modes are predictable, which is exactly what makes them manageable.

Failure one: it folds

Sycophancy is a model dropping a correct answer because you pushed back, not because you were right.



14.66%

How often a model that had given the right answer abandoned it for a wrong one after the user pushed back.



Failure two: it invents sources

A citation that looks real and formats correctly is still a claim. Open it before you repeat it.



BY THE NUMBERS

18%

Share of the citations GPT-4 produced in one study that pointed at nothing at all.



Same model, different job

**Summarising a document
you supply**

2 to 5% error.

**Short factual recall with no
tools**

Around 40%.

There is no single accuracy rate.



What to do about each one

1. Ask before you tell, because framing changes the answer.
2. Push back once, then check who folded.
3. Open every source.



The tool is useful once you know where it breaks

Teach the failure modes before the shortcuts. That order matters more than the tool.

